

YOUR GUIDE TO BUILDING WORK

Extending your Spanish home and adding it to the deeds

A new terrace, a closed porch or an extra room adds value only when the paperwork matches. This guide shows the steps from licence to deeds.

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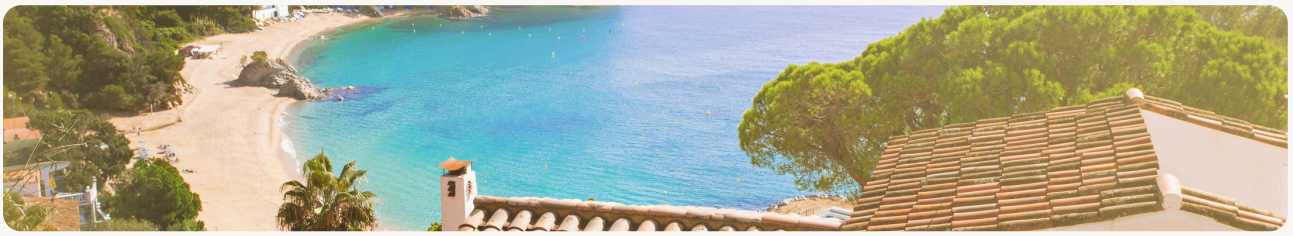
INTRODUCTION

The building and the paperwork must match

In Spain, a home exists three times: on the ground, in the Land Registry and in the Catastro. When you extend it, all three have to show the same thing, or selling and borrowing against it gets harder.

The essentials at a glance

- Most building work needs a licence or a formal notice to your town hall before it starts.
- A finished extension is added to the deeds with a declaración de obra nueva at a notary.
- The Catastro must be updated, which usually raises the cadastral value and the IBI.
- An extension missing from the deeds can delay or block a sale.
- Older works can often be put right, but the rules differ by region.



From licence to deeds

Follow these steps in order, and keep every document. You will need them again when you sell.

01 Get the licence

Larger works, such as a new room, need a licencia de obra mayor with an architect's project. Smaller works often need only a declaración responsable, a formal notice to the town hall.

02 Finish and certify the work

When the work is done, the architect issues a certificate of completion, the certificado final de obra.

03 Sign the declaration at a notary

The declaración de obra nueva describes the new building in a public deed. It carries a stamp duty set by your region.

04 Register it and update the Catastro

The deed is recorded at the Land Registry and the change is reported to the Catastro. Your next IBI bill will reflect the larger home.

When the extension is already there

Many homes bought by foreigners have a closed terrace or extra room that never made it into the deeds. It is a common problem, and often a fixable one.

Check before you buy

Compare the nota simple and the Catastro record with what you see on the visit. If the home is bigger than the papers say, ask for it to be regularised before you sign.

Regularising older works

Works old enough that the town hall can no longer act against them can often be added to the deeds with a technician's certificate of age. The time limit and the steps differ from region to region.

Get local advice

A local architect or lawyer can tell you quickly whether your works can be registered, and what it will cost.



03 BUENO ACCOUNT

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01 Our team is there when you need us, by phone, WhatsApp, chat and email.

02 You register a direct debit change in the app, and we handle the rest.

03 You can see what your home is worth today and keep your property papers in one place.

04 We file your Spanish non-resident tax return, the Modelo 210, for you.

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